CAPABILITY PORTFOLIO · PUBLIC SECTOR AI WORKFORCE DEVELOPMENT

Building AI-Ready Workforces. Designing Learning Systems That Deliver Results.

Strategic learning design, AI workforce development, and digital transformation support for institutions navigating the future of work.



Dr. Barbara Zá Franks, EdD

AI Learning Architect · Workforce Development Strategist · Digital Transformation Consultant

Education Executive · Learning Experience Designer · AI-Enabled Learning Systems Specialist

> Helping organizations translate AI innovation into workforce capability, measurable learning outcomes, and sustainable institutional transformation.

50+ campuses served by AI-enabled language arts programming I lead	**~35,490** assessment items architected across five intervention courses	**1,200+** students across eight campuses under my academic and operational leadership	**18 yrs** of education, training and institutional leadership

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ONLINE PORTFOLIO
bzafranks.github.io/public-sector-ai/
Interactive sample module
Reference register

DOCUMENT
Version 1.0
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Independent portfolio, not a government document

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Learning science, leadership and implementation, combined

Dr. Barbara Zá Franks is a Bahamian education executive and AI learning architect based in Freeport, Grand Bahama. Over 18 years she has worked across K–12, online and international education, moving from the classroom to Chief Academic Officer of a multi-campus international school network.

She currently owns K–12 Language Arts programming for 50+ Alpha Schools campuses at 2 Hour Learning, with responsibility spanning curriculum, assessment, intervention, analytics and AI-generated learning systems, working alongside learning science, product and engineering teams. As Chief Research Officer (consulting) at Virtuous Sea Corporation, she leads applied research on workforce readiness and labour-market trends.

> **Positioning:** I work alongside AI engineers, software developers, Ministry departments, external technology vendors and government leadership. My role is learning, assessment and implementation lead. I am not a provider of infrastructure, cybersecurity or AI models.

QUALIFICATIONS

Doctor of Education (EdD) in Leadership
American College of Education, 2025

Master of Education (MEd) in Educational Leadership
American College of Education, 2014

Bachelor of Arts in International Relations
Lynn University, 2004

Teacher and K–12 administrative certifications (District of Columbia)

Core capabilities

01

AI Workforce Capability Development

Defining what AI-capable performance looks like by role, then building the pathways, practice and support to get there.

Verified: I own K–12 Language Arts programming across 50+ Alpha Schools campuses, spanning curriculum, assessment, intervention, analytics and AI-generated learning systems.

02

Learning Experience & Curriculum Architecture

Designing complete learning systems, from competency maps and course structures to lessons, practice and media.

Verified: I built five intervention courses (209 components, 974 subskill lessons, about 35,490 assessment items) to a defined rigour specification.

03

AI-Supported Learning Products

Shaping AI-enabled learning products with engineering and product teams: requirements, content models, quality rules and evaluation.

Verified: I led the move from manually assembled content to versioned, auto-graded, specification-driven learning objects, working with product and engineering teams.

04

Competency & Assessment Frameworks

Designing competency frameworks, mastery rules and assessment item banks that measure real capability, including scenario-based tasks.

Verified: I designed standardised assessments using QTI response formats, DOK expectations and AI-graded production items, and I diagnose construct-validity problems.

05

Learning Analytics & Evaluation

Defining indicators, dashboards and evaluation designs that show leaders who is progressing, who is at risk and what is working.

Verified: I designed live dashboards tracking enrolment, mastery, stalled progress and item performance, and I lead program efficacy and mixed-methods research.

06

Institutional Implementation & Capacity Building

Leading rollout across sites and teams: policy, quality assurance, training of trainers, coaching and change management.

Verified: As Regional Dean and Chief Academic Officer, I directed operations, policy, faculty development and quality assurance across a multi-campus network.

SELECTED AI LEARNING & ASSESSMENT PROJECTS

Building learning systems at scale

01 Scalable AI-Enabled Curriculum and Assessment Architecture

2 Hour Learning / Alpha Schools · AI-Driven English Language Arts Learning Strategist | Curriculum DRI

Content had to be built at very high volume and still be rigorous, consistent, mapped to standards and usable by adaptive software. That could not be done one lesson at a time.

50+ campuses in scope	**5** Language intervention courses (Grades 3–7)	**209** course components	**974** subskill lessons

DOCUMENTED

- Own Language Arts programming across Grades K–12 for 50+ campuses
- Directly Responsible Individual for Grades 3–8 Language Arts and PreK–12 Vocabulary: program strategy, product requirements, quality assurance and implementation
- Course and program architecture, standards mapping and rigour calibration

PROPOSED APPLICATION

- A public service AI curriculum built once as a modular architecture, then reused across ministries and roles
- Scenario-based item banks that test safe, correct AI use in realistic government tasks
- Specifications that let the Ministry, DICT or an external vendor build learning content to one quality standard

02 Analytics-Driven Learning Performance and Intervention Systems

2 Hour Learning / Alpha Schools · AI-Driven English Language Arts Learning Strategist | Curriculum DRI

Some learners were on the wrong level, some assessments were mis-calibrated, and some students had no active course assignment. All of these were hidden in system-wide data.

Grades 3–8 Language placement reviews across the system	**3,530** learner vocabulary baseline analysed to target intervention	**182** vocabulary lists in an intervention content catalogue	**Live** dashboards: enrolment, mastery, stalled progress, item performance

DOCUMENTED

- Individual placement and performance reviews using MAP RIT scores, XP, accuracy and time-on-task data
- Querying student data across all campuses to identify and resolve enrolment gaps
- Item-level analysis to surface mis-calibrated, low-rigour or decontextualised questions

PROPOSED APPLICATION

- An adoption and capability dashboard showing participation, competency and confidence by department
- Early identification of teams that need coaching or follow-up support
- Assessment quality review, so pilot results reflect real capability and not test artefacts
- Honest evaluation that separates correlation from causation when reporting programme impact

This experience comes from K–12 education. It shows I can design and scale learning systems. It is not evidence of public service workforce outcomes. No confidential employer information, student data or proprietary content is included.

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Leading institutions and evidence

03 Multi-Campus Institutional Learning and Professional Development

KnowledgeLink · Barstow Schools in China · St. Mary's Online Academy · Chief Academic Officer

Teaching quality, policies and standards had to be consistent across several campuses and an online program. Each site was growing and had its own staff, culture and regulatory needs.

8 campuses under academic & operational management	**1,200+** students across those campuses	**900+** students in one middle & high school I led	**2019–25** progression from Dean of Faculty to Chief Academic Officer

DOCUMENTED

- Directed academic operations for a multi-campus network of American international schools (Chief Academic Officer)
- Directed academic and operational management across eight campuses serving more than 1,200 students
- Standardised academic policies, handbooks and course catalogues; led curriculum alignment and audits

PROPOSED APPLICATION

- Consistent AI training standards and quality assurance across ministries, departments and agencies
- Training-of-trainers and departmental AI champion networks
- Policy-aligned onboarding so new public officers learn approved AI practice from day one

04 Applied Workforce Research and Evaluation

Virtuous Sea Corporation · Chief Research Officer (fractional / consulting)

Turning mixed qualitative and quantitative evidence into findings that are credible, ethical and useful to decision-makers.

Multi-year research agenda on workforce readiness & outcomes	**Mixed-methods** survey, interview & data-analysis studies	**EdD** doctoral qualitative research on leadership & retention

DOCUMENTED

- Lead applied research strategy and a multi-year research agenda, including workforce readiness and career outcomes
- Design survey instruments, research protocols, regression analyses and mixed-methods studies
- Supervise research staff and collaborators for methodological rigour, data integrity and ethical compliance

PROPOSED APPLICATION

- A formal training needs assessment and AI capability baseline for public officers
- Pre- and post-pilot evaluation design with ethical data handling
- Evidence-based scale-up recommendations for Ministry leadership

Full case studies: bzafranks.github.io/public-sector-ai/case-studies.html

PROPOSED FRAMEWORK · ILLUSTRATIVE

Public Service AI Capability Framework

This is an illustrative consulting framework, offered for possible adaptation by the Ministry. It is not an adopted government framework.

LEVEL 1 · UNDERSTAND
AI Foundations

AI literacy · Capabilities & limitations · Responsible use · Data privacy · Human oversight

Explains what AI can and cannot do, and when not to use it.

LEVEL 2 · USE
AI Productivity

Drafting · Summarisation · Research support · Communication · Everyday knowledge work

Uses approved tools safely for routine tasks and verifies every output.

LEVEL 3 · APPLY
Role-Specific Application

Administrative staff · Human resources · Finance · Policy development · Managers & departments

Applies AI to the real tasks and rules of their own role.

LEVEL 4 · IMPROVE
Advanced AI-Enabled Workflows

Workflow redesign · AI-assisted analysis · Automation concepts · Evaluation · Responsible implementation

Redesigns team processes and evaluates AI use against risks and benefits.

LEVEL 5 · SUSTAIN
Sustainable Adoption & Performance

Competency validation · Performance support · Coaching · Analytics & adoption monitoring · Continuous improvement

Capability is validated, supported and improved over time.

Across every level: Privacy & data protection · Accuracy & verification · Confidentiality · Human accountability

A final framework would be built through stakeholder consultation and aligned with existing Ministry initiatives, such as the National AI Literacy Initiative. It would also be based on a formal training needs assessment.

Why this matters

AI transformation succeeds when technology, people, learning, and organizational systems are developed together.

Technology needs workforce readiness
Licences and platforms create opportunity. Results come only when staff can use them confidently in their own roles.

AI tools alone do not guarantee productivity
Gains depend on good task selection, verifying outputs, and redesigning workflows. Access alone does not deliver them.

Role-specific pathways matter
A finance officer, an HR officer and a policy analyst use AI differently. One generic course cannot serve them all.

Training must be measurable
Effective programmes combine assessment, practical application, ongoing support and outcome indicators. Attendance is not enough.

Responsible use is a skill
Human judgement, privacy safeguards and awareness of governance must be taught and checked. They cannot be assumed.

Proposed strategic perspective. This describes my professional view, not an existing Ministry programme. Try the interactive sample module (Levels 1–2).

ILLUSTRATIVE 90-DAY PILOT

Public Service AI Workforce Readiness and Learning Design Pilot

> This is an illustrative proposal. The scope, staffing, systems access and schedule would all need to be agreed with the Ministry.

PHASE 1 · DAYS 1–20

Discover

Discovery, stakeholder engagement, training needs assessment and capability baseline.

- Stakeholder map and interview summary
- Training needs assessment instrument and findings
- AI capability baseline for pilot cohorts

PHASE 2 · DAYS 21–45

Design

Competency framework, role-specific pathways, curriculum prototypes and assessment design.

- Draft competency framework (adapted Levels 1–5)
- Two or three role-specific pathway outlines
- Prototype modules and scenario-based assessments

PHASE 3 · DAYS 46–70

Deliver

Training delivery, user testing, performance support and feedback.

- Pilot delivery to agreed cohorts
- Job aids and performance-support resources
- Mid-pilot feedback and usability findings

PHASE 4 · DAYS 71–90

Evaluate

Evaluation, adoption analysis, refinement and scale-up recommendations.

- Pilot evaluation report
- Refined modules and framework
- Scale-up roadmap and recommendations

Proposed indicators

> These are proposed indicators, not achieved results. Targets would be set with the Ministry after the baseline.

Participation & completion
Enrolment, attendance and module completion by cohort

Competency gain
Pre- and post-training competency against the framework

Scenario performance
Results on realistic, role-based assessment tasks

Appropriate AI use
Correct task selection and safeguard application

Employee confidence
Self-reported confidence before and after

Tool adoption
Use of approved tools, where data is available

Workflow proficiency
Observed or self-reported proficiency on target workflows

Participant feedback
Relevance, quality and usefulness ratings

Scaling readiness
Evidence-based recommendations for the next phase

POTENTIAL ENGAGEMENT MODELS

Flexible ways to work together

I am flexible about the form of engagement. It could be a defined project, an advisory role, an institutional partnership or another suitable arrangement. Work can be delivered personally or through D.R.E.A.M. Learning Solutions.

AI Workforce Learning Design Consultant
Designs the end-to-end AI learning architecture for public officers.

AI Literacy & Capacity Building Specialist
Builds foundations and productivity programmes, and trains trainers.

Learning Experience & Curriculum Architect
Designs pathways, modules, media and content standards.

Digital Transformation Training & Adoption Adviser
Aligns training with tool rollout, change management and support.

Learning Systems & Assessment Consultant
Builds competency frameworks, item banks and certification rules.

Program Evaluation & Learning Analytics Specialist
Designs needs assessments, indicators, dashboards and evaluation.

Alignment with documented priorities

- The Ministry's four pillars are Modernize Government, Build Future Readiness, Develop Bahamian Talent and Drive National Development. It brings together DICT, the Digital Transformation Unit, BNSI and the National Development Plan Secretariat. *(Confirmed; ZNS Bahamas, 18 June 2026 (speech of 15 June 2026))*
- The Minister stated the Government will establish a National AI Literacy Initiative, with online and in-person training to be made available across the public service. *(Planned / announced; Bahamas Information Services, 16 June 2026)*
- The site lists a Microsoft 365 rollout (Teams, SharePoint, Copilot, OneDrive) across the public service as "in progress". *(In progress, per Ministry website; Ministry website (mindbahamas.com), Undated (accessed 11 Nov 2026))*
- The Bahamas Future Skills Academy ("a national platform, online and in-person"), a Bahamas AI Skills Initiative and a Smart Government Portal of AI tools for the public service are listed as "planned". *(Planned, per Ministry website; Ministry website (mindbahamas.com), Undated (accessed 11 Nov 2026))*
- The Minister announced plans to establish a National Artificial Intelligence Committee to draft the country's first AI legislation, and plans for a national ID card with privacy and security protections. *(Planned / announced; The Tribune, 16 June 2026)*

Request a strategic consultation

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Labels: Verified experience = verified professional achievement; Public source = verified ministry initiative; Proposed = proposed consulting capability; Illustrative = illustrative concept or demonstration. **Independence:** This is an independent professional portfolio. It does not represent, and is not endorsed by, the Government of The Bahamas or the Ministry of Innovation and National Development. No existing relationship, vacancy, budget or contract is implied. References to government initiatives are drawn from public sources listed in the reference register. Full register: bzafranks.github.io/public-sector-ai/sources.html.